Interview Transcript - Niko

Speaker 1: Okay, first question. What do you care about, just in general?

Speaker 2: Just in general, I care about my family, my friends, my girlfriend, my hobbies, and work. Honestly, just having a nice work-life balance, because I used to not have that. I used to always be scrambling to devote attention to one thing at a time while neglecting others. But life is really about finding a balance between all those things, figuring out how to make everybody you care about happy, and working hard within reason. So that's what means the most to me.

Speaker 1: How would you say you've found that balance?

Speaker 2: Definitely through a lot of trial and error. I've figured it out by doing a lot of the wrong things. For example, I am a proprietary trader as well as an engineer. My engineering job is a typical nine-to-five, and then at 5 p.m., the Asian futures market opens up. I'll trade anytime between about 5 and 9 p.m. There have been nights when I've stayed up until 2 a.m. or even 6 a.m. when the London session opens in Europe.

I've realized that it's not worth my time to work that hard and stay up that late because then I'm miserable the next day. I've done that for weeks on end, and I've also realized I'm not spending enough time with the people who mean the most to me or giving them the attention they deserve. That can damage your relationships, especially with friends.

Seeing how your presence affects the people you care about most helps you understand that you have to be there for other people, too. I also like to work out, and not sleeping well or getting enough rest makes my gym sessions worse. Everything gets messed up if you don't maintain a proper balance between sleep, work, and everything else.

Speaker 1: What kind of activities are you a part of? It could be clubs, teams, classes, games, group chats, religious or family activities, or anything like that.

Speaker 2: That's just work to me, between gym training and my engineering positions. But my actual hobbies are fishing and pickleball. Fishing is probably one of my favorite hobbies. I started playing pickleball a couple of years ago when it started getting popular, and now my buddies and I go play at least a couple times a week.

Fishing was a lot easier in the summer when the weather was nicer, especially on weekends. Now it's getting a little more difficult because I've been busy. Sometimes I play video games, but I wouldn't necessarily call that a hobby. It's more occasional and usually with friends. I don't really do too much outside of spending time with friends and family, fishing, and playing pickleball.

Speaker 1: How do you want to connect with people? Who do you want to connect with, how often, and in what kind of setting?

Speaker 2: Three of my best friends work at my family's cafe, so whenever I'm not traveling for work or out at the hospital, I'll sometimes go into the cafe and hang out with them while they're working.

A lot of my buddies and I also go to the gym together. A couple of my other friends trade with me, so I work with them on a day-to-day basis and then hang out with them outside of work.

I have a pretty small friend group, probably a maximum of about 10 guys, and we all know each other and hang out. It's just about finding a time that works for the majority of people because there's always going to be someone who can't make it.

We try to plan things regularly so everybody can see each other throughout the week, whether that's at the cafe, at the gym, on the pickleball courts, or just on Discord. Sometimes we use Discord to talk while playing different games or just catch up late at night.

It's really about keeping the connection because it's kind of hard in the modern world, especially when you're young, out of school, working, and busy with other responsibilities. Sometimes I just try to text my friends or give them a call and catch up every once in a while. That's usually how I stay in touch with everybody.

Speaker 1: Is there anything you think would help you stay in touch with other people more or make it easier to connect with them?

Speaker 2: Honestly, the biggest thing that will help anyone connect with people is just thinking about yourself less. I know it sounds strange, but when you start thinking about others more and how they might be feeling, you realize how your presence affects them.

People either depend on you or care a lot about you, and it's your responsibility to reach out and let them know you're there for them. You have to let them know you care. You have to reach out and be somebody who extends the invitation to talk or hang out. It's about realizing your own mistakes and making an effort to be there for other people.

Speaker 1: What's getting in the way of connecting with people? Is it time, money, distance, energy, confidence, not knowing where to start, or feeling like you always have to reach out first?

Speaker 2: I think honestly, for the majority of people, it's time and money. It's about working. The reason I work so much and have two different jobs is because I'm young and out of school, and I want to build up my future.

I think a lot of people my age are in the same position. They're focused on working, paying off student loans, buying a house, or just getting started in their lives. It's a strange time because, for the first time, your priorities are more focused on working than going out and having fun.

Priorities also change depending on where people are in life. I'm 24, and I have friends who are 27 or 28 who already have houses and steady jobs. Then I have other friends who are 20 or 21 and still finishing college. Those few years can make a big difference because people have very different priorities and interests depending on their circumstances.

I would say the biggest obstacles are time and money. It's not necessarily about who reaches out first. I have friends who reach out to me all the time, and I always try to get back to them and make sure they know I want to spend time with them. I'm just busier with work.

Even my best friend recently asked if I wanted to go to the ranch, but I couldn't because I was trading at that time. That happens pretty regularly. People ask me to hang out or do things, and sometimes my schedule just doesn't allow it. I'm very schedule-oriented, so weekends are usually easier. It's more difficult during the week.

Speaker 1: What about distance? Does that play a role, especially as you start traveling more?

Speaker 2: Yes. I also have a few best friends from college. One is all the way out in Wisconsin, one is in Chicago, and another is in Illinois. It's been hard for me to see them. The last time I saw them was about a year and a half ago, and that makes me feel terrible.

But we text each other almost every day in our group chat. That's how we stay connected. It's important to be able to stay in touch, and a click of a button can show somebody that you still care about them. Even if I can just send somebody a quick text, video, or message, it makes things better for everybody.

Speaker 1: Do you feel like texting and group chats are enough to maintain those friendships, or do you think spending time together in person is still important?

Speaker 2: I definitely think spending time together in person is important. Texting helps keep the relationship alive, especially when you can't see somebody regularly, but it's not really the same as actually being around them. You can text someone every day, but there's something different about sitting down with them, having a conversation, and doing something together.

I think you need both. Staying in touch through messages is great, but you also have to make an effort to see people when you can. Otherwise, you can go a really long time without actually spending quality time together.

Speaker 1: Do you think it's harder to make new friends now compared to when you were in college or school?

Speaker 2: Definitely. When you're in school, you're constantly around people your age. You have classes, activities, sports, and other things that naturally bring people together. You don't really have to put that much effort into meeting people because you're already in the same environment.

Once you graduate, everybody starts going in different directions. People move, get jobs, start relationships, and have different schedules. You have to be more intentional about meeting people and maintaining friendships. It's not necessarily that people don't want to make friends anymore. It's just that there aren't as many opportunities built into your everyday routine.

Speaker 1: Do you think having a regular activity or hobby makes it easier to maintain friendships?

Speaker 2: Absolutely. I think that's one of the easiest ways to stay connected. For example, playing pickleball with my friends a couple times a week gives us something consistent to look forward to. You don't have to come up with a completely new plan every time you want to hang out.

Having something in common makes it easier because you're already doing an activity together. It also gives everybody a reason to get out of the house and spend time with each other. I think that's why activities like going to the gym, fishing, or playing sports are so good for friendships.

Speaker 1: If you had more free time, what would you want to do more often with your friends?

Speaker 2: Probably just more spontaneous things. Going fishing, playing pickleball, going to the gym, or even just grabbing food somewhere. It doesn't always have to be something planned out or a big event. Sometimes the best times are when somebody just calls you and asks if you want to go do something.

I would also like to travel more and visit some of my friends who live farther away. It's just difficult to coordinate everyone's schedules, but I think those are the kinds of things that are important to make time for.

Speaker 1: Do you think technology makes it easier or harder to connect with people?

Speaker 2: I think it does both. It definitely makes it easier to stay in touch with people who live far away. You can send a text, call someone, or jump into a group chat whenever you want. That's something that wasn't always as easy for previous generations.

At the same time, I think people can get too caught up in social media and just communicating through their phones. Sometimes people feel like they're staying connected because they're seeing what everybody is doing online, but that's not really the same as having an actual conversation. I think technology is great as long as you're using it to support your relationships instead of replacing them.

Speaker 1: Do you have any advice for someone who might be struggling to maintain friendships or make time for other people?

Speaker 2: I would say don't overthink it. Just reach out. Even if it's been a while since you've talked to somebody, there's nothing wrong with sending a quick message and asking how they're doing. I think people sometimes assume that if somebody hasn't reached out, they don't

care, but that isn't always the case. People are busy, and everyone has their own things going on.

You also have to be willing to make the effort yourself. You can't always expect somebody else to be the one initiating plans or conversations. If you care about someone, show them. Make time for them when you can, even if it's just a quick phone call.

Speaker 1: Is there anything else you think people could do to make maintaining friendships easier?

Speaker 2: I think people should make smaller commitments instead of always waiting for the perfect opportunity to get together. You don't need to plan a whole weekend or go somewhere expensive. You could grab coffee, go for a walk, work out together, or just stop by and say hello.

I think sometimes people make connecting with others more complicated than it needs to be. If you have 30 minutes available, you can still make an effort to see somebody or catch up. Those smaller interactions add up over time and help keep relationships strong.

Speaker 1: Do you think having a consistent routine with friends would make a difference?

Speaker 2: Yes, definitely. That's part of why I like having certain activities that we do regularly. When you know that you're going to see somebody every Tuesday or play pickleball a couple times a week, it takes away the pressure of constantly having to make plans.

It becomes part of your schedule, just like going to work or going to the gym. I think if more people made time for their friendships that way, it would be easier to stay connected even when life gets busy.

Speaker 1: Looking ahead, how important do you think maintaining these relationships will be as you get older and your responsibilities change?

Speaker 2: I think it's going to become even more important. As you get older, people are going to have families, careers, houses, and all kinds of other responsibilities. It's probably only going to get harder to find time to see everybody.

But I don't think that means you should let those relationships go. The people who have been there for you throughout your life are important, and you have to make an effort to keep them around. I think it's something you have to prioritize just like anything else that matters to you.

Speaker 1: Is there anything else you would like to add?

Speaker 2: No, I know I was rambling for a little bit, but I think I said enough.

Speaker 1: Yeah, that's good. Thank you for taking the time to talk with me!

Speaker 2: Of course! Happy to help.

Interview Transcript – Stacy

Speaker 1: Okay, to start, what do you care about most in your life right now?

Speaker 2: Definitely my family. My two girls are a huge part of my life, and a lot of the decisions I make revolve around them. One is in high school, and my oldest is in college, so they're both at very different stages of life. I also care about my marriage, my friendships, my career, and making sure I have time for myself. I think as a mom, it's really easy to put everybody else's needs before your own, but I've learned that you have to take care of yourself, too. Otherwise, you can't really show up for everyone else the way you want to.

Speaker 1: How has your life changed as your daughters have gotten older?

Speaker 2: It's changed a lot. When they were younger, everything revolved around school drop-offs, activities, practices, and just making sure they were where they needed to be. Now they're becoming more independent, which is exciting but also a little strange. My oldest is away at college, so I don't get to see her every day anymore. My youngest is still at home, but she's busy with high school, friends, and her own activities.

I think I'm learning that being a mom looks different at every stage. Sometimes they need you to be involved in everything, and other times they just need you to be available when they want to talk.

Speaker 1: What kinds of activities or groups are you involved in?

Speaker 2: Most of my activities are centered around my family and work. I'm involved with my youngest daughter's school and some of her activities, and I try to stay involved in what's going on with my oldest at college, too. I also enjoy going to workout classes, meeting friends for lunch, and occasionally doing things with other moms.

I have a few close friends that I've known for years, and we try to get together whenever we can. Sometimes it's dinner, sometimes it's just meeting for coffee. I also enjoy going on walks and spending time outside when the weather is nice.

Speaker 1: How do you usually connect with other people? Who do you spend the most time with?

Speaker 2: Most of my time is spent with my family, especially my youngest since she's still at home. I also stay connected with a group of friends I've known for a long time. We have a group text that we use pretty regularly, and it's an easy way to keep up with everybody.

I think at this stage in life, friendships are a little different. You're not necessarily seeing your friends every day like you might have when you were younger. Instead, you have to be more intentional about making plans. I try to see my friends at least once every couple of weeks, even if it's just for a quick lunch.

Speaker 1: Do you find it harder to maintain friendships now that you have more family responsibilities?

Speaker 2: Definitely. Between work, the girls' schedules, and everything else, it can be hard to find time. Especially when my girls were younger, I felt like I was constantly driving somewhere or taking care of something. I would sometimes go weeks without seeing certain friends.

Now that they're older, I have a little more flexibility, but there are still a lot of things going on. My oldest comes home from college occasionally, and when she does, I really want to spend that time with her. I think it's just about figuring out how to balance everything and understanding that you can't be everywhere at once.

Speaker 1: How do you stay connected with your daughter who's away at college?

Speaker 2: We text pretty much every day. Sometimes she'll call me when she's walking back from class or when she has some free time. We also FaceTime occasionally, especially if there's something going on that she wants to tell me about.

I try not to overwhelm her because I know she's busy and trying to enjoy her college experience. I want her to feel independent, but I also want her to know that I'm always here. Sometimes it's just a quick message asking how her day is going or reminding her that I love her. Those little things make a difference.

Speaker 1: Do you think technology has made it easier to maintain relationships with people who live farther away?

Speaker 2: Absolutely. I can't imagine how difficult it would have been to have a daughter away at college without texting or FaceTime. It's nice to be able to check in and feel like you're still part of each other's lives even when you aren't physically together.

The same goes for my friends. We have group chats where we share pictures, talk about what's going on, or make plans. It doesn't replace actually seeing someone, but it definitely helps maintain that connection in between visits.

Speaker 1: How do you make time for yourself outside of being a mom and managing your household?

Speaker 2: I'm still working on that honestly. I enjoy working out, going on walks, and getting together with friends. Sometimes even running errands by myself feels like a little break. I think moms get so used to having a schedule built around everybody else that you almost forget what you enjoy doing on your own.

I've gotten better about making plans for myself and not feeling guilty about it. Whether that's going to a workout class or meeting a friend for dinner, I think it's important to have things that are just for you.

Speaker 1: Is there anything you wish you had more time for when it comes to connecting with people?

Speaker 2: I would probably say spending more quality time with my girlfriends. It's easy to say we should get together, but actually finding a date and making it happen is another story. Everyone has their own schedules, kids, work, and responsibilities.

I also wish I could visit some friends who live farther away more often. Sometimes months go by before we see each other, even though we talk regularly. I think as you get older, you realize how important those friendships are, and you don't want to lose them just because life gets busy.

Speaker 1: What's the biggest thing that gets in the way of maintaining those relationships? Is it time, money, distance, energy, or something else?

Speaker 2: Time and energy are probably the biggest things. By the time I finish work, take care of things at home, and get through everything the girls have going on, sometimes I just want to sit down and relax. Even if I have the time to make plans, I don't always have the energy.

Distance can be an issue, too. Some of my friends live in different parts of town, and getting everybody together takes planning. I also think money can play a role because going out to dinner or planning activities can get expensive. Sometimes it's easier to just stay home.

Speaker 1: Do you feel like you're usually the one reaching out to make plans, or is it pretty equal between your friends?

Speaker 2: I think it's pretty equal. There are definitely a couple of friends who are better about initiating plans than others, but I think we all understand that life gets busy. Sometimes I'll reach out, and other times someone else will. I don't really keep track of who makes the first move.

I do think it's important that everybody makes an effort, though. Friendships can't be one-sided. Even if you can't get together, responding to a message or checking in lets someone know you're thinking about them.

Speaker 1: Do you think friendships change as you get older, especially as your children become more independent?

Speaker 2: Yes, absolutely. When your kids are younger, a lot of your friendships revolve around other parents. You meet people through school, sports, birthday parties, and other activities. As your children get older, those connections can change because you're not necessarily seeing those parents as often.

At the same time, I think you start appreciating your longtime friendships even more. You want people around you who know you outside of being a mom or having a certain role. It's nice to have friends you can talk to about anything, not just your kids or work.

Speaker 1: What would make it easier for you and your friends to get together more often?

Speaker 2: I think having something consistent would help. Instead of constantly trying to find a date that works, it would be nice to have a regular girls' night or a monthly lunch that everyone knows about ahead of time. Even if not everyone can make it every time, at least there's something planned.

I also think keeping things simple makes a difference. It doesn't always have to be dinner at a nice restaurant or a big event. Sometimes meeting for coffee, going for a walk, or having someone over for a glass of wine is enough.

Speaker 1: If you could create the ideal way to stay connected with friends and family, what would that look like?

Speaker 2: Probably something that makes it easier to coordinate schedules and actually follow through with plans. I feel like everyone wants to spend more time together, but the hardest part is finding a time that works for everyone.

I would love to have something where you could see when people are available and make plans without going back and forth through 50 text messages. I also think reminders would be helpful because sometimes things get planned and then everyone gets busy and forgets.

Speaker 1: Do you think other moms experience the same challenges when it comes to maintaining friendships and finding time for themselves?

Speaker 2: Definitely. I think it's something a lot of moms experience, especially when they're balancing work and children at different stages of life. You're constantly trying to be there for everyone, and friendships sometimes end up being the thing that gets pushed to the side.

I think a lot of women want to spend more time with their friends, but they don't always know how to fit it into their schedules. It's not that they don't care. It's just that there are so many competing priorities.

Speaker 1: What advice would you give to another mom who feels like she's lost touch with her friends?

Speaker 2: I would say just reach out. Don't feel like you need a special reason or a big plan to reconnect with somebody. Send a text, make a phone call, or ask someone to grab coffee. Even if you haven't talked in months, most people are happy to hear from you.

I would also say don't wait until life slows down because I don't think it ever really does. There will always be something going on. You have to make time for the people who are important to you, even if it's just in small ways.

Speaker 1: Is there anything else you would like to add about relationships, friendships, or staying connected?

Speaker 2: I think it's really important to remember that relationships take effort at every stage of life. Whether you're raising kids, working, or becoming an empty nester, you still need people outside of your immediate family. Your friendships are an important part of who you are.

I also think it's important to give yourself some grace. Not every friendship needs constant communication, and that doesn't mean it's not meaningful. Some of my closest friends are people I might not see for a month, but when we get together, it's like no time has passed. It's about having people who genuinely care about you and making an effort to keep those relationships in your life.

Speaker 1: That's great. Thank you so much for taking the time to talk with me!

Speaker 2: Of course! It was nice talking about it. I think it's something a lot of people can relate to.

Interview Transcript – Lex

Speaker 1: Okay, to start, what do you care about most in your life right now?

Speaker 2: I would say my family, my friends, school, and just having fun. I'm at a point where I feel like there's always something going on, whether it's school, sports, homework, or making plans with friends. I care a lot about spending time with the people who are important to me. I also care about doing well in school because I know my grades are going to matter for college. But I also don't want to spend all my time worrying about school and miss out on being a teenager.

Speaker 1: How do you balance school, activities, and your social life?

Speaker 2: Honestly, it's pretty difficult sometimes. During the week, most of my time is spent at school, doing homework, or going to practices. By the time I get home, I usually have something else I need to do. I try to get my homework done early so that I have time to hang out with friends or do something on the weekends.

Sometimes I definitely procrastinate, though, and then I end up having a really busy night. I think I'm still figuring out how to manage my time better.

Speaker 1: What kind of activities or groups are you involved in?

Speaker 2: I'm involved in a couple of school activities, and I play sports. I'm also part of a few different friend groups at school. Most of my social life comes from school because that's where I see everybody every day.

Outside of school, I like going shopping, getting food with friends, going to football games, and just hanging out. Sometimes we go to someone's house or watch movies. I also spend a lot of time on social media, especially Snapchat and TikTok.

Speaker 1: How do you usually connect with people? Who do you spend the most time with?

Speaker 2: Mostly my friends from school. I have a smaller group of really close friends, but I also know a lot of people through classes and activities. I probably spend the most time with my closest friends because we have similar schedules and classes together.

We have a group chat where we talk pretty much every day. We send pictures, make plans, and talk about random things. Sometimes we don't even have anything important to say, but it's just fun to keep the conversation going.

Speaker 1: Do you prefer hanging out with people in person or connecting through social media?

Speaker 2: Definitely in person. I think social media is fun, and it's an easy way to stay connected, but it's different from actually being together. Sometimes you can spend hours texting someone, but it's not the same as going somewhere and making memories.

I do think social media makes it easier to keep up with people, especially if you don't see them every day. But I would rather hang out with my friends than just talk to them over my phone.

Speaker 1: Is it difficult to make new friends at school?

Speaker 2: I think it can be, especially if you're new or don't know many people. A lot of people already have their friend groups, and sometimes it can feel intimidating to try to join them. Once you start talking to people in class or through activities, it gets easier.

I think having something in common helps a lot. If you're on the same team or have a class together, you already have something to talk about. It's easier to become friends when you see someone regularly.

Speaker 1: Do you think social media makes it easier or harder to maintain friendships?

Speaker 2: I think both. It's easier because you can always message someone or see what they're doing. Even if you don't see a friend at school that day, you can still talk to them online.

But I also think social media can make friendships more complicated. Sometimes people see pictures of their friends hanging out without them, and they can feel left out. There can also be drama over things people post or messages that get misunderstood. I think sometimes people focus too much on what everyone else is doing instead of enjoying their own friendships.

Speaker 1: What's something you wish you had more time for when it comes to connecting with people?

Speaker 2: I wish I had more time to hang out with friends outside of school. During the week, everyone has homework, sports, and other activities, so it's hard to get everyone together. Even on weekends, people sometimes have family plans or other things going on.

I also wish I had more time to see some of my friends who go to different schools. We still talk, but we don't get to see each other as often as we used to.

Speaker 1: What's the biggest thing that gets in the way of spending time with friends? Is it time, money, distance, energy, or something else?

Speaker 2: Probably time and transportation. Most of us can't drive ourselves everywhere yet, so sometimes we have to rely on our parents to take us places. Even if everyone wants to hang out, it's hard to coordinate when people have different schedules.

Money can also be an issue. A lot of the things we want to do cost money, like going shopping, getting food, or going to the movies. Sometimes we just want to hang out without having to spend anything.

Speaker 1: Do you feel like you're usually the one making plans, or do your friends reach out to you?

Speaker 2: It's pretty equal. Some of my friends are better at making plans than others, but we usually all contribute. Sometimes someone will just send a message in the group chat asking what everyone is doing that weekend.

I think it's easier when someone actually suggests something instead of everyone saying they want to hang out but never deciding what to do.

Speaker 1: Do you ever feel like you're missing out when your friends make plans without you?

Speaker 2: Yes, definitely. I think that's pretty normal, especially with social media. If you see your friends posting pictures or videos from somewhere and you weren't invited, it can make you feel left out.

Sometimes there's a reason you couldn't go or maybe it was just a smaller group, but it's still hard not to take it personally. I think that's one of the downsides of always seeing what everyone is doing online.

Speaker 1: What do you think would make it easier for you and your friends to spend more time together?

Speaker 2: I think having more things to do that don't cost a lot of money would help. Sometimes we just want somewhere to go or something fun to do without having to spend $30 every time we hang out.

It would also help if there were more activities for high school students that weren't necessarily school-related. I feel like a lot of places are either meant for little kids or adults, and there aren't always many options for teenagers.

Speaker 1: Would you rather have planned activities or more spontaneous opportunities to hang out?

Speaker 2: Probably a mix of both. I like having plans to look forward to, especially on weekends, but sometimes the best times are when someone randomly asks if you want to go get food or hang out.

The hard part is that everyone has different schedules, so planning ahead is helpful. But I don't think every time you see your friends needs to be a big planned event.

Speaker 1: Do you think friendships will change after high school?

Speaker 2: Definitely. I think about that a lot, especially with college coming up. Some of my friends might go to different colleges or move to different states, and we won't be able to see each other every day anymore.

I hope we stay close, but I know it's going to take more effort. Right now, we see each other at school without even having to plan anything. After graduation, we're going to have to actually make plans and stay in touch.

Speaker 1: What do you think is the best way to stay connected with friends when everyone goes to different colleges?

Speaker 2: I think group chats and FaceTime will help a lot. We already use those pretty regularly, so I think we'll keep doing that. It would also be fun to plan weekends when everyone comes home or visit each other at school.

I think the biggest thing is just making an effort. Even if you can't talk every day, checking in every once in a while helps. I don't think you have to constantly talk to someone to still be good friends.

Speaker 1: If you could change one thing about how you and your friends connect, what would it be?

Speaker 2: I would probably make it easier to plan things. A lot of times, we spend more time trying to figure out what everyone wants to do than actually doing something. Someone will suggest hanging out, but then nobody can decide where to go or when everyone is free.

I think it would be nice to have a better way to see when everyone is available and come up with ideas that work for the whole group.

Speaker 1: What advice would you give to someone who is having a hard time making friends or feeling included?

Speaker 2: I would say try to put yourself out there, even if it's uncomfortable at first. Talk to someone in class, join a club, or get involved in something you're interested in. You never know who you might meet.

I also think it's important to remember that you don't need a huge group of friends. Having a few people you can really trust and be yourself around is more important than knowing everybody.

Speaker 1: Is there anything else you would like to add about friendships and staying connected?

Speaker 2: I think friendships are a really important part of being in high school. A lot of your memories from this time in your life come from the people you're spending it with. Even though school and activities keep everyone busy, I think it's important to make time for your friends.

I also think people should be more understanding when someone can't make plans. Just because someone is busy doesn't mean they don't want to spend time with you. Everyone has different things going on, and sometimes you just have to make an effort to understand that.

Speaker 1: That's great. Thank you so much for taking the time to talk with me!

Speaker 2: Of course! Thanks for asking!